



VACANCY NOTICE – 2026-JRC.B.3-SVQ-FGIV-003095

Policy analyst – Administrative Capacity, Governance and Policy Experimentation

Type of contract	Member of the European Commission 's contract staff, Function Group IV (article 3b of the Conditions of Employment of Other Servants)
Duration of contract	36 months (renewable up to maximum 6 years)
Area	Territorial development
Place of employment	Seville (ES)
Indicative basic salary	4.449,31 - 6.444,59 € (applicable as of 1 st of July 2025) For more detailed information please consult: Working Conditions

WE ARE

The [Joint Research Centre \(JRC\)](#) provides independent, evidence-based knowledge and science, supporting EU policies to positively impact society.

The current vacancy is with the **Territorial Development Unit** within the **Fair and Sustainable Economy Directorate** of the JRC.

The mission of our Unit is to support the territorial articulation of the EU policy agenda, its external investment and global outreach. Our aim is to deliver world-class science-for-policy support to bring Europe closer to citizens and places, turning territorial diversity into value.

We aim at strengthening the EU global role in putting forward place-based solutions for competitiveness and sustainability and localising global agendas, bringing back to Europe what we learn from outside.

We build on a unique combination of knowledge, data, methods, analytical and modelling tools as well as extensive links to urban, local, rural, regional, national and international stakeholders, authorities and communities.

Our unit is a stimulating, friendly and multicultural workplace, where personal development, growth and initiative are encouraged. We are a very supportive and dynamic team, and we offer an inclusive environment, with full respect of appropriate work-life balance. Our unit has around half of its staff in the JRC Seville site (Spain) and half in the JRC Ispra site (Italy).

We offer a position of policy analyst to conduct research and analysis on the role local and regional governments play in achieving EU policy objectives. This ranges from the analysis and assessment of administrative capacity and governance approaches of local and regional authorities to action research with local and regional governments on important policy areas such as affordable housing, competitiveness or climate policy.



We offer:

- High-quality working conditions and good work-life balance in a dynamic environment;
- Working in a multidisciplinary and multicultural team;
- A unique opportunity to support EU policies and contribute to the JRC's scientific excellence interacting with policy makers, academics and other stakeholders, including participation in both policy and scientific fora.

The job is located in the vibrant city of Seville, which hosts around 400 European Commission staff (including economists, engineers, and computer and social scientists) from all EU-27 Member states, being the second-largest JRC site and the fourth-largest site of the European Commission.

Please see also [Working at the Commission – conditions and environment \(europa.eu\)](https://ec.europa.eu/euro-jrc/en/working-at-the-commission-conditions-and-environment).

WE PROPOSE

The jobholder will mainly have the following tasks:

- Carry out analysis on the local and regional implementation of EU policy, identifying barriers and enablers of policy implementation, including the assessment of administrative capacities and governance at regional and local level and the identification of improvement measures.
- Contribute to the design, implementation and assessment of policy and regulatory experimentation approaches to support innovation in local public policy.
- Contribute to drafting technical reports, policy briefs and peer-reviewed academic papers.
- Present, coordinate and discuss policy-relevant analyses and research findings with policymakers at various territorial levels, including the provision of responses to ad hoc requests for information and policy insights, translating research findings into actionable policy advice.
- Ensure active engagement with other Commission DGs, to maximise the policy impact of the work.
- Contribute to the preparation and management of contracts with experts, external research organisations or other contractors, including project and financial documentation.

The work involves collaboration with other JRC units and other Commission DGs, international organisations, national, regional and local authorities and other relevant policy and scientific stakeholders. The post may require occasional travel.

WE LOOK FOR

We seek a dynamic **mixed-methods policy researcher** with **expertise in local governance, policy experimentation, qualitative analysis, indicator development, and territorial data analysis**, capable of transforming qualitative evidence from local authorities into robust measurement frameworks that can be integrated with socio-economic and territorial datasets for comparative policy analysis.

You must demonstrate (essential):

- A Ph.D. or at least 3 years of proven experience in research and analysis on one or more of the following areas: (local/regional) public policy, public administration, territorial development, political science, regional studies, urban studies, economics, (economic/human) geography, sociology (governance or organisation focus) or similar fields.
- Strong qualitative research skills (including analysing qualitative data systematically using coding, thematic analysis...) and ability to integrate qualitative and quantitative evidence.
- A very good knowledge (C1) of English.
- Excellent drafting skills for technical and non-technical audiences and excellent presentation and stakeholder engagement skills.

The following experience and knowledge will be considered an advantage (desirable):

- Experience as an applied policy researcher combining skills from public policy, social science research, facilitation and stakeholder engagement, and evaluation.
- Ability to operationalise qualitative concepts (administrative capacity, institutional trust, quality of governance, collaboration) and transform them into observable dimensions and measurable indicators.
- Understanding of the realities of local and regional government (how municipalities and regional administrations function, political and administrative decision making processes, multi-level governance...).
- Experience with quantitative data analysis and composite indicators as well as with assessment framework development (indicator design, scorecards, maturity models, typologies, index construction).
- Experience with designing and implementing action research and/or policy experimentation (theory of change approaches, realist evaluations, learning-oriented monitoring frameworks) and production of policy-relevant insights from the evidence gathered.
- Evidence of fieldwork with public authorities and management of multi-stakeholder engagement processes.

HOW TO APPLY

If you are **already on a valid CAST FG IV reserve list**, or you **have already applied to one of the calls below**, you can directly submit your application at [JRC Recruitment Portal](#).

If not, before applying to this position, **you must register** for one of the two following databases:

- the [Call for Expressions of Interest | EU Careers \(europa.eu\)](#) (CAST Permanent FG IV), which is used by a wide range of organisations (institutions, bodies, offices and agencies of the European Union), or
- the [call for researchers](#) (JRC Call COM/1/2015/GFIV – Research), which is mainly used by the JRC.



Note that each of the calls above has **different minimum eligibility requirements and different selection tests**.

The JRC cultivates a workplace based on respect for other people and the environment and embraces non-discriminatory practices and equality of opportunity. In case of equal merit, preference will be given to underrepresented nationalities as well as to the gender in minority.